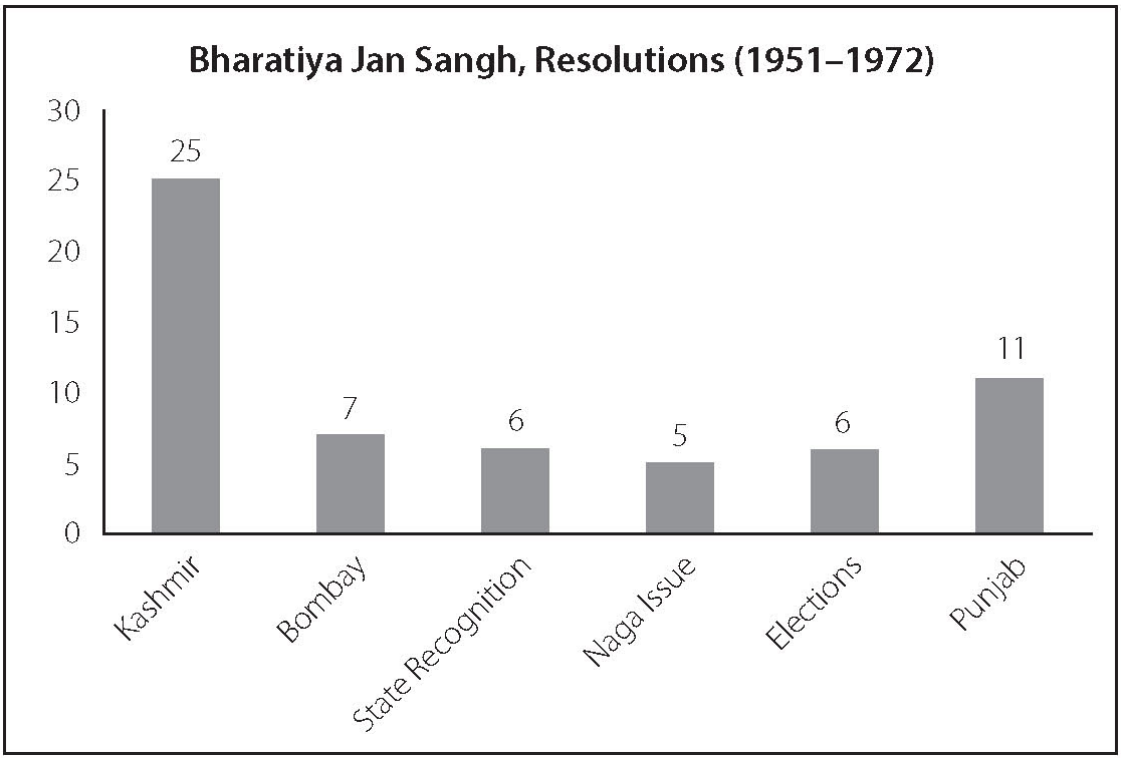
Revealingly, in 1953, when Jan Sangh leaders sat in a conference to finalise a new constitution for the party, they simultaneously passed a resolution demanding the 'full accession of Kashmir State to India failing which the integration of Jammu and Ladakh with Indian territory'.[82]

Figure 9.2: Jan Sangh Saw Kashmir as Its Most Important Internal Political Concern (1951–1972)



Source: Author's statistical analysis of all Jan Sangh Resolutions on Internal Affairs (1951–1972). Bharatiya Jan Sangh Party Documents, 1951–72, Vol. 4: Resolutions on Internal Affairs (New Delhi: Bharatiya Jan Sangh, 1973)

By the time the Jan Sangh was formed, Kashmir's special constitutional status, and Sheikh Abdullah's National Conference's insistence on retaining it, had come under strong attack from the Hindu community of Jammu, led by the Praja Parishad, and Buddhist groups from Ladakh. The Praja Parishad had been set up by RSS pracharak Balraj Madhok (later a founding member of the Jan Sangh) in November 1947, with the aim of forcing full integration of the state with India. In India's only Muslim-majority state, it received